

Motifs of the kopou phool (foxtail orchid) — an integral part of a Bihu dancer's attire and a symbol of love, fertility and merriment — occupies a pride of place. Besides these, the majestic Brahmaputra River — the lifeline of Assam — finds representation in the terminal's design, reflecting its pivotal role in the region's history, culture, tourism and agriculture.

The design also incorporates large, open spaces with skylights to let in plenty of natural light. Indoor gardens and green walls are also integrated in a bid to improve air quality and absorb carbon dioxide.

To be sure, the design has been conceived in keeping with the concept that the airport is more than just a transportation hub — it is a living, breathing reflection of the region's natural and cultural identity. It celebrates the resilience of bamboo, the grace of orchids, and the seamless integration of these two elements into a sustainable, iconic airport design.

Bamboo Holds the Design Key

The extensive use of bamboo in construction highlights the significance of eco-friendly construction of the building. A vertical indoor forest, featuring various local art forms and holographic figures, has been planned at the arrivals section of the terminal. This innovative feature will highlight the rich cultural tapestry of Assam, showcasing the N-E's most populous state's artistic heritage amid lush biodiversity.

Passenger Management

Designed to manage 13.1 million passengers per annum (MPPA) by 2032 and 34 Air Traffic Movements (ATMs) per hour with the addition of a new taxiway, the terminal will be a first-of-its-kind in the region. With the new terminal, the airport will have 14 entrance gates, including four DigiYatra gates, to help streamline document

checks and expedite the check-in process.

Strategic Importance

The Bamboo Orchids terminal is strategically important for multiple reasons. First, it will serve as the primary aviation gateway to the N-E, facilitating better connectivity within India and with international destinations. This improved connectivity is expected to boost tourism, trade, and investment in the region, paving the way for economic development. Second, the terminal is expected to generate numerous employment opportunities, both during its construction and once it becomes fully operational.

GIAL's Vision

GIAL envisions the new terminal as a world-class aviation hub that embodies sustainability, innovation and cultural pride. With a focus on creating a seamless travel experience, GIAL aims to set new benchmarks in airport infrastructure

and passenger services in the region. The Bamboo Orchids Terminal stands as a testament to this vision, combining aesthetic appeal with functional efficiency. This vision, supported by the collaboration of the best of minds in architecture and design, smart technologies, local aesthetics and sustainable practices, will mark a new era in airport economics.

It will showcase how integrating sustainable architecture with cultural elements can create spaces that are both environmentally responsible and deeply rooted in local identity. By weaving local artistry into its design and emphasising eco-friendly practices, the upcoming facility not only aims to enhance passenger experience but also to foster a deep connection with Assam's heritage. As it prepares to welcome millions of passengers in the coming years, this remarkable facility will undoubtedly serve as a beacon of progress, blending tradition with modernity and setting new standards in airport excellence.

